Week 3 Milestone Worksheet

Instructions: Provide responses to all items in the boxes. The worksheet consists of Sections A-E. Work on this worksheet one section at a time throughout your week, and return to Savanna after each section for the next set of content and further instructions.

SECTION A: Problem Statement

Step 1: Your GCGO

Which Grand Challenge or Great Opportunity (GCGO) do you want to play a part in addressing? (Pick one.)

As a reminder, the GCGOs are:

- Urbanization
- Education
- Infrastructure
- Healthcare
- Climate change
- Governance
- Job creation
- Agriculture
- Natural resources
- Arts, culture, and design
- Tourism
- Empowerment of women
- Regional integration
- Wildlife conservation

GCGO: empowerment of women

Step 2: Describe Your Problem

You are going to take a first pass at briefly describing your chosen problem. This can be any problem that speaks to you, as long as it is a real-life occurrence that is clearly linked to your chosen GCGO, that occurs in a certain place and for certain people (and/or animals), and that it can be clearly defined.

For example, if you chose wildlife conservation as your GCGO, you might first state your chosen problem as:

There are very few white rhinos left in Kenya, and they are in danger of becoming extinct.
Another example is if you choose infrastructure as your GCGO:

Residents of major cities in South Africa endure prolonged periods without electricity, significantly hampering their ability to generate income.

Note that this is just your first attempt at stating the problem, and you don't need to quantify it yet. In order to get to your official problem statement (which does need to be quantifiable), first answer the following questions. The more specific your answers, the better. You may also ask Google, Wikipedia, ChatGPT, and/or other reliable online sources to help you. Please be sure to cite (give credit to) any sources that you use.

Describe your problem using What/Who/When/Where/Why/How….

What Women's empowerment remains limited, especially in education, leadership, and financial access.
These gaps persist globally despite policy efforts.
It affects personal growth and national development

Who Marginalized women—rural, single mothers, and young girls—are most affected. Stakeholders include governments, NGOs, and community leaders. The ripple effect impacts families and economies
When The issue spans decades and remains urgent today. Progress has been inconsistent due to pandemics and instability. Action is key before the 2030 SDG deadline.
Where Most severe in regions like Sub-Saharan Africa, South Asia, and the Middle East. In Ethiopia, women still struggle with access and representation. Global initiatives have yet to reach full effectiveness
Why Empowering women improves health, education, and the economy. Without it, poverty and inequality persist. It's both a moral and strategic priority.
How Solutions include legal reform, education access, and entrepreneurship. Tech platforms and mentorship can accelerate impact. Local programs and global support must work in tandem.

Step 3: Understand and Quantify Your Problem

Next, you will conduct some basic web research to better understand, define, and quantify your problem. You will do this through a combination of Google search,

Wikipedia, credible web sources, ChatGPT or other AI research tools, and your own synthesis of information from these sources. Be sure to give credit to your sources, and paraphrase (use your own words) rather than quoting directly.

What is the historical context for this problem? What happened in the past that contributes to the problem now?

For centuries, Ethiopian women were denied access to education, leadership, and property rights.
Cultural norms promoted domestic roles and discouraged ambition outside the home.
Legal efforts began in the 1990s, but enforcement has been slow and inconsistent.
Deep-rooted beliefs and systemic inequalities still limit opportunities today.
These historical patterns continue to shape modern challenges in empowering women.

What are the possible economic (money-related) reasons why this problem exists and continues?

Women lack access to credit, land ownership, and financial literacy programs.
They earn less in formal jobs and are overrepresented in informal labor.
Entrepreneurship is harder due to low investment and poor market access.
Unpaid domestic work limits income-generating potential.
Gender-focused initiatives often lack funding and policy enforcement.

What are the possible political reasons why this problem exists and continues?

Despite increased female representation, many women hold symbolic or low-influence positions.
Weak enforcement of gender policies and lack of political will hinder real progress.
Civil society groups advocating for women face restrictions and limited freedom.

Political discourse often sidelines women's issues and priorities.
Quota systems boost numbers but don't guarantee meaningful decision-making power.

What cultural beliefs and/or social norms possibly contribute to this problem?

Traditional gender roles prioritize women as wives and mothers, limiting their public and professional participation.
Early marriage is widely practiced, despite legal restrictions, reinforcing dependency and limiting education.
Patriarchal norms discourage women from speaking out or pursuing leadership roles.
Biased language and social expectations normalize gender-based violence and inequality.
Tight cultural norms and high power distance make it difficult to challenge existing structures.

Who are the people potentially responsible (directly or indirectly) for creating and/or maintaining this problem?

Government leaders and policymakers who delay or underfund gender equity initiatives.
Community elders and religious leaders who reinforce traditional gender roles.
Employers who perpetuate wage gaps and limit women's career advancement.
Families and peers who discourage girls from pursuing education or leadership.
Institutions that fail to enforce laws protecting women's rights and safety.

Now that you have the preliminary information you need, you'll continue your web research to find some numbers, or quantifiable information, to help describe your problem:

What numerical data can you find that is relevant to your problem? Be sure to use your own words and also cite (give credit to) your sources.

Example 1:

According to Chat GPT, there are about 880 white rhinos currently living in Kenya. This population is very small, and they are critically endangered.

Example 2:

Johannesburg has approximately 5.8 million residents (per ChatGPT) and had approximately 4.7 million international overnight visitors in 2019 (according to the South African Tourism Annual Report for 2019/2020).

Approximately how many people (and/or animals) are **directly** impacted by this problem? Explain.

In Ethiopia, approximately **30 to 40 million women and girls** are directly impacted by the problem of limited empowerment. This includes those facing barriers in education, healthcare, employment, leadership, and legal rights.

Most affected are women of reproductive age (15–49), who make up nearly **24% of the population**, and those living in rural areas, where **83.6%** of Ethiopians reside. These women often lack decision-making power, access to financial resources, and protection from gender-based violence.

The ripple effects extend to children, families, and communities—impacting health outcomes, economic growth, and social stability. Empowering women isn't just about individual rights; it's about transforming entire systems.

Approximately how many people (and/or animals) are **indirectly** impacted by this problem? Explain.

Indirectly, **over 100 million people** in Ethiopia are impacted by the limited empowerment of women. This includes children who receive less education and healthcare when mothers lack decision-making power, men whose households suffer economically, and communities that miss out on the benefits of inclusive development.

When women are disempowered, entire families face reduced income, poor nutrition, and limited access to services. Nationally, this slows progress in education, health, and economic growth. Even animals are affected—especially livestock—when women farmers lack access to veterinary care or agricultural training.

What other numerical data can you share that is relevant to your problem? What can you find out about its size and scope? What can be measured? (For example, the amount of trash produced in Nairobi each day, the number of people without access to clean water, etc.)

Only **6% of Ethiopian women in union** were considered empowered in 2016, up from 2% in 2005.

More than **80% of women in union** are not empowered in education, with **90% of rural women** lacking basic literacy.

Just **20% of women in union** had regular paid employment in 2016, up from 10% in 2005.

Empowerment is **27% in urban areas** but only **2% in rural areas**, showing a stark

divide.
Regions like Somali, Afar, and Benishangul-Gumuz report the **lowest empowerment rates**, some as low as **1%**.

Step 4: Describe Your Solved State

Without having to come up with *how* to solve the problem, describe what the desired, solved state looks like. Please use numbers wherever possible, and make your solved state-specific and measurable.

Example 1:

There would be a population of 10,000 healthy and protected white rhinos living in the wild in Kenya.

Example 2:

All 5.8 million residents of Johannesburg would have affordable and consistently available power from clean energy sources, 99.5% of the time.

If the problem were addressed/solved, what would reality be like?

Women across urban and rural areas would have equal access to education, healthcare, and financial resources.
They'd participate actively in leadership, entrepreneurship, and decision-making at all levels of society.
Families would benefit from improved health, income, and education outcomes, especially for children.
Communities would experience reduced poverty, gender-based violence, and

social inequality.
National development would accelerate, driven by inclusive growth, innovation, and resilience.

Are there other benefits that would come from your problem being solved? Name at least one.

one powerful benefit is **improved child wellbeing**. When women are empowered, they're more likely to invest in their children's education, nutrition, and healthcare.

This leads to better school attendance, lower child mortality rates, and stronger long-term development outcomes.
Empowered mothers also pass on knowledge and values that foster resilience and opportunity in future generations.
It's a ripple effect: healthier, educated children grow into empowered adults who uplift their communities.
Solving this problem doesn't just change women's lives — it transforms entire societies.

Step 5: Clarify Your Problem Scope

You are more effective at solving a problem when you know where its limits are. That is, when you know what is "in scope" and "out of scope." For this reason, it is important to list what is out of scope, or NOT included as part of your problem definition.

Example 1:

The scope of the problem does not cover any other animal species besides white rhinos. It does not include white rhinos outside of Kenya.

Example 2:

The scope of the problem does not include any businesses or people outside of the legally-defined Johannesburg city limits. It does not apply to tourists or visitors staying for less than 1 year in Johannesburg.

What is NOT in the scope of your problem?

It does not cover empowerment efforts in high-income countries or global gender trends.
It excludes men's empowerment or broader gender-neutral policies.
It doesn't focus on unrelated sectors like climate change or infrastructure development.
Animal welfare and wildlife conservation are not part of this issue.
It avoids temporary campaigns that lack long-term structural impact.

Step 6: Areas for Learning

What do you not know or understand that you would like to know more about? This can be anything related directly or indirectly to your problem. Let your curiosity run wild!

Example 1:

I'd like to know where most of the demand for rhino horn is coming from. I'd like to know who are the primary buyers and who is behind the trafficking of rhino horn. I'd

like to know how long the average rhino's lifespan is. I'd like to know how many babies a typical female rhino has, and how many babies typically survive into adulthood. I'd like to know more about what diseases impact rhinos. I'd like to know more about the kinds of habitats that rhinos thrive in. I'd like to understand what international organizations do the best job supporting wildlife conservation and what their practices are. I'd like to know what models of community involvement have been most successful in keeping wildlife safe and thriving. I'd like to understand how much land is available in Kenya for rhinos to roam.

Example 2:

I'd like to better understand the utility company Eskom and its history. I'd like to understand why Eksom has failed to plan properly to update its infrastructure. I'd like to understand the relationship between Eksom and the South African government. I'd like to know if there are private utility companies providing competition to Eksom. I'd like to know what the latest breakthroughs are in solar power. I'd like to know what other possible energy sources might be made available in Johannesburg. I'd like to know how much energy tourists and temporary visitors use. I'd like to better understand the process of how limited energy supply gets allocated to people and businesses. I'd like to better understand the economic impact on people and businesses of not having power.

What else would you like to know or understand better? (It can be anything related to your problem.) List 5-10 things.

1.What specific policies or laws exist to support gender equality in Ethiopia, and how effectively are they enforced?

2.How does access to digital technology (smartphones, internet) differ between men and women, especially in rural areas?

3.What are the employment trends for women in urban vs. rural Ethiopia, and which sectors are most accessible to them?

4.How do local cultural beliefs vary across regions regarding girls' education and women's leadership?

5.What are the main barriers to accessing affordable childcare, and how do they impact women's career choices?

6.How does women's economic participation influence household income, children's education, and community growth?

7.What role do religious institutions and leaders play in shaping perceptions of women's roles and rights?

Step 7: Problem Statement

This step is the culmination of all you have done in Part A. You will synthesize the work you have done above to create a problem statement of 150 - 250 words. This should be in narrative form, 2-4 paragraphs, and should NOT use bullet points.

Your problem statement should:

- Provide a succinct description of the problem **in the first sentence**.
- Indicate the specific population affected
- Explain the impact (cost, time, environmental, personal) and why the problem matters.
- Explain what reality would be like if the problem were solved. The gap between present reality and the desired outcome should be clear.

Please cite (give credit to) where your information came from directly in your statement. Avoid word-for-word quoting and instead paraphrase (use your own words), as modeled in the example. Also, list your sources and their URLs (web addresses) at the end.

Example :

Kenya's white rhinos are in critical danger of extinction. There are currently about 880 white rhinos in the country of Kenya, per Wikipedia. According to Chat GPT, Rhinos are considered a keystone species, meaning they have a disproportionately large impact on their ecosystem compared to their population size. Rhinos help shape their environment by influencing vegetation growth and acting as seed dispersers, which creates habitat for other species (per ChatGPT).

The extinction of white rhinos would have cascading effects on other plant and animal species in their habitat. According to the Kenya Wildlife Service, rhinos' presence in reserves and parks brings millions of tourists each year, contributing to

local economies and supporting conservation efforts. Once a species goes extinct, it is gone forever. The extinction of rhinos would represent the loss of millions of years of evolutionary history and unique genetic diversity that science has yet to fully understand and benefit from (per ChatGPT).

My problem would be considered solved when the population of wild, white rhinos in Kenya reaches 10,000, and when all imminent threats to their population including poaching and habitat destruction are not present. If this were the reality, it would create ecosystem balance, create large revenues from ecotourism, preserve important cultural symbols, and allow for genetic diversity that could benefit humanity in ways we may not yet fully understand.

Sources:

Kenya Wildlife Services Annual Report 2017, https://www.kws.go.ke/content/annual-reports

ChatGPT, https://chat.openai.com/

"White Rhinoceros", Wikipedia, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/White_rhinoceros

My problem is statement is:

In Ethiopia, the persistent lack of women's empowerment remains a deeply rooted challenge, especially for those in rural and marginalized communities. Despite years of policy efforts and global attention, millions of Ethiopian women still face major barriers to education, financial independence, leadership, and safety. This problem directly affects women and girls—particularly those of reproductive age—who are systemically excluded from opportunities that could improve their lives and contribute meaningfully to society.

The consequences of this disempowerment are profound. Women earn less than men, have limited access to land or credit, and spend significant time on unpaid

domestic work, which restricts their ability to pursue education or paid employment. Culturally, early marriage and rigid gender norms reinforce cycles of dependency and silence. Politically, female representation often lacks real influence, and gender-based policies remain underfunded or poorly enforced. This imbalance stunts national development and perpetuates poverty, limiting the social and economic progress of entire communities.

If fully addressed, the reality for Ethiopian women would shift dramatically. They would have equal access to education, employment, leadership roles, and financial tools. Families would be healthier, communities more resilient, and national productivity would rise. Closing this empowerment gap isn't just about fairness—it's a transformative pathway toward inclusive growth, social stability, and generational change

Please list all sources that you used to form your problem statement:

copilot,https://copilot.microsoft.com

Please go back to Savanna and continue with your learning content. You will be prompted on when to return to complete Section B.

SECTION B: Research Questions & Hypothesis

IMPORTANT: Complete this section AFTER completing the Savanna Modules ***Asking Effective Questions*** and ***conducting web research.***

Step 8: Research Questions

Based on what you have learned so far and on 'Step 6: Areas for Learning' from this worksheet, come up with 3 research questions. **Research questions should be complex enough that they can't be answered by a single Google search.** If appropriate, form a hypothesis that your research may confirm or reject. (As a reminder, a hypothesis is a prediction of how you think your research will answer your research question. It is your best guess. If you truly have absolutely no idea, state "not applicable.")

Example Research Question #1:

What are some ways can we increase rhino populations?

Hypothesis:

Rhino populations will increase by creating more open spaces for them to roam, increasing their protection, increasing international interest in them, and for other reasons, I have yet to uncover.

Example Research Question #2:

Which organizations have been effective at wildlife conservation and what practices do they use?

Hypothesis:

Not applicable; I don't know.

Example Research Question #3:

How many babies can a typical female white rhino have in her lifetime, and what are the reasons a female may not have high fertility?

Hypothesis:

A typical female white rhino can have 5 babies in her lifetime, and fertility may be affected by diet, amount of grazing territory, poaching, stress, mate availability, and other reasons I have yet to uncover.

Research question #1:

How do regional cultural norms and religious beliefs across Ethiopia influence women's access to education, leadership, and financial independence

Hypothesis (if applicable):

Cultural norms and religious interpretations vary significantly across Ethiopia, and in regions with more conservative views, women are less likely to access education and leadership opportunities.

Research question #2:

What impact does access to digital technology have on economic empowerment opportunities for women in rural Ethiopian communities?

Hypothesis (if applicable):

Limited digital access—due to cost, infrastructure, and literacy—reduces women's ability to participate in markets, access online education, and leverage entrepreneurial tools.

Research question #3:

How effectively are national gender equity policies implemented at the local level, and what factors influence their enforcement

Hypothesis (if applicable):

Weak enforcement mechanisms, lack of funding, and low awareness among local officials contribute to the gap between policy design and practical impact

STOP

Please go back to Savanna and continue with your learning content. You will be prompted on when to return to complete Section C.

PART C: Peer Activity Report

IMPORTANT: Complete this section AFTER completing the Savanna Lessons "Hub Activity: Problem Statement" and "Hub Activity: Web Research."

Peer Activity #1: Problem Statement

Please report on your process of getting peer feedback.

Who reviewed your problem statement (item #19)? (Give the first and last names of your 2 peers.) Yeabsira Daniel Yeabsira goitom
In brief, what feedback did they give to you? Admired the work I put on to get background histories and do researches and told me to keep it up
Was their feedback useful to you? Did it feel kind? Why or why not? Yes, it motivated me
Who did you give feedback to? (Give the first and last names of 2 peers- they may be the same or different peers from above.) Yeabsira Daniel Yeabsira goitom

Do you feel that you gave useful and kind feedback to your peers? Why or why not? Hopefully they got the most out of my feedback and yes I belive it was helpful

After you updated earlier parts of the worksheet based on your feedback, please go back to Savanna and continue with your learning content. Return to Part E prior to submitting your milestone.

PART D: Daily 3 Challenge Report

Please answer the following questions honestly. There are no wrong answers! This is your opportunity for self-reflection.

How many days out of the past 7 did you do 20 minutes of movement? 4
How many days out of the past 7 did you write 3-morning pages? 6
Overall, how do you feel you are doing on building your Daily 3 habits? Explain. It helped me feel like im in control of my self and it was very motivating
What is your biggest barrier to staying motivated? My procastination
If you have been practicing at least some movement and/or morning pages:

A) What effect (if any) have you noticed on your mood, focus, and productivity?

Yes indeed, i noticed that i payed more attention to my mental health

B) What helps you stay motivated?

To be a better person

If you haven't been practicing any movement and morning pages, what would motivate you to get started?

Reading articles or watching documentaries of successful people

Once you have completed this worksheet:

1. Export/convert to .pdf.
2. Rename it per the instructions.
3. Upload to Savanna as your Milestone 3 Submission.
4. **Celebrate a job well done!**